

Post-incident review PIR-2026-056

Mobile Backend: partial outage

Contoso Platform Engineering. Fictional sample data.

Summary

On 29 January 2026, Mobile Backend experienced partial outage in production (AU Southeast) for about 25 minutes. The error-rate alert paged the on-call engineer. Investigation found that the disk on the primary node filled with transaction logs.

Impact

Users of Mobile Backend saw partial outage for about 25 minutes. The service owner, Mobile Engineering, led the response.

Timeline

- 09:11 First signal received.
- 09:23 Incident declared and on-call team engaged.
- 09:58 Likely cause identified.
- 10:02 Mitigation applied.
- 10:54 Service confirmed healthy and incident closed.

What happened

Investigation found that the disk on the primary node filled with transaction logs.

The team first suspected a recent configuration change, but the change log showed nothing relevant.

It took time to work out which team owned the affected component.

All traffic depended on one component with no standby.

The change was made outside the approved maintenance window.

What went well

Responders communicated clearly in the incident channel and the status page was updated within fifteen minutes of the incident being declared.

Actions

- Review alert thresholds so the alert only fires when action is needed.
- Add a circuit breaker and timeout on the upstream call.
- Assign a named owner for the component in the service catalogue.